

## Component 3: Appraising

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### Overview

The purpose of this component is to assess students' listening and appraising skills through the study of music across a variety of styles and genres. The content is grouped into four areas of study, each of which contains two set works.

This component gives students the opportunity to reflect on, analyse and evaluate music in aural and/or written form. To achieve these objectives students need to use their knowledge and understanding of musical elements, musical contexts and musical language to make critical judgements about the repertoire and context of music within the areas of study. These critical judgements will require the use of attentive listening, aural perception and specific music vocabulary associated with a particular style or genre. These areas of study also provide opportunities for students to demonstrate their contextual understanding of music when performing and composing.

Students will learn the content of musical elements, musical contexts and musical language through four compulsory areas of study. The areas of study and set works are:

| Area of study                           | Set works                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Instrumental Music<br/>1700–1820</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• J S Bach: 3rd Movement from Brandenburg Concerto no. 5 in D major</li><li>• L van Beethoven: 1st Movement from Piano Sonata no. 8 in C minor 'Pathétique'</li></ul>                                     |
| <b>Vocal Music</b>                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• H Purcell: Music for a While</li><li>• Queen: Killer Queen (from the album 'Sheer Heart Attack')</li></ul>                                                                                              |
| <b>Music for Stage and Screen</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• S Schwartz: Defying Gravity (from the album of the cast recording of Wicked)</li><li>• J Williams: Main title/rebel blockade runner (from the soundtrack to Star Wars Episode IV: A New Hope)</li></ul> |
| <b>Fusions</b>                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Afro Celt Sound System: Release (from the album 'Volume 2: Release')</li><li>• Esperanza Spalding: Samba Em Preludio (from the album 'Esperanza')</li></ul>                                             |

There are two set works in each area of study, and these will allow students to develop their knowledge and understanding of musical elements, musical contexts and musical language through the context of these pieces. Students should also study a range of pieces beyond these set works. The suggested wider listening pieces for each area of study (see *Appendix 4: Suggested wider listening*) provide students with breadth, enabling them to place their knowledge of musical elements, musical contexts and musical language in a wider context, and apply their knowledge and understanding to more pieces of music. The suggested wider listening will help students to relate their learning to other pieces of music, but its study is not compulsory. Teachers can identify and teach other pieces of music to support their students' learning.

# Content

## Knowledge and understanding

Students need to learn about the following in order to critically appraise pieces of music through the contexts of areas of study:

- form and structure of the music
- appropriate musical vocabulary for each work
- stylistic features of the music, for example the Baroque features to be found in the music
- conventions used in different times and places
- how music relates to the context in which it was created
- how to express and justify their opinions and preferences.

Students need to demonstrate their knowledge and understanding of musical elements, musical contexts and musical language in relation to music that they have studied and to unfamiliar music for each of the areas of study.

## Musical elements

This includes:

- organisation of pitch (melodically and harmonically), including simple chord progressions, for example perfect and imperfect cadences, and basic melodic devices
- tonality, including major, minor and basic modulations within the music, for example tonic, dominant
- structure; organisation of musical material, including simple structure, for example verse and chorus, call and response, binary and theme and variations
- sonority, including recognition of a range of instrumental and vocal timbres and articulation, for example legato and staccato
- texture, how musical lines (parts) fit together, including simple textural combinations, for example unison, chordal and solo
- tempo, metre and rhythm, including pulse, simple time, compound time, and basic rhythmic devices, for example dotted rhythms
- dynamics; basic dynamic devices, for example crescendo and diminuendo.

These musical elements can be applied to many different types of music but may not be applicable to every single area of study or set work to the same degree or extent.

The use of the musical elements above should be used to understand how, as appropriate to each area of study and set work:

- to identify how instrumentation is used in different combinations (identifying instruments and groups of instruments)
- the instrumentation is used to good effect, including playing techniques etc associated with a particular instrument or group
- to identify musical and melodic devices (ornamentation, ostinati, riffs, use of imitation, pedal point and sequence)
- to identify rhythmic devices and features (syncopation, swung rhythms, dotted rhythms and triplets)
- to identify and discriminate between major, minor, modal, pentatonic, and chromatic tonalities
- texture is used, including how the music exploits textural contrasts with reference to monophony, homophony, polyphony, heterophony etc
- musical devices are used, such as ostinato/riff, sequence, repetition, pedals and drones
- harmony and chord patterns are used in the music
- the effects of music (e.g wah wah, flanger, continuo – see Appendix 3 for more examples).

## **Musical contexts**

This includes:

- the effect of purpose and intention (for example of the composer, performer, commissioner) on how music is created, developed and performed in different historical, social and cultural contexts
- the effect of audience, time and place (for example venue, occasion) on how music is created, developed and performed in different historical, social and cultural contexts.

## Musical language

This includes:

- reading and writing of staff notation, including treble-clef and bass-clef note names, rhythmic notation in simple time, key signatures to four sharps and four flats
- major and minor chords and associated chord symbols, including traditional and contemporary notation as appropriate, for example IV or G7
- recognising and accurately using appropriate musical vocabulary and terminology related to the areas of study, for example slide, repeats and stepwise
- recognising and accurately using appropriate terminology related to scores (e.g. continuo)

Students should have an understanding of key stylistic features and be able to use appropriate music language and terminology in their answers. For example, students should be able to describe a repetitive melody in a classical piece as an 'ostinato' but also to use the correct term of 'riff' when describing the same feature in a piece of popular music. When describing musical textures, the description of 'thick' or 'thin' is not appropriate in the description of a homophonic or polyphonic passage. Students should understand the appropriate and correct musical vocabulary to use when appraising each of the set works.

The Music vocabulary list in *Appendix 3* lists vocabulary and terminology that supports the learning of musical elements, musical contexts and musical language. The list indicates the level and scope of technical language expected from students at this level. The list is not exhaustive. The words listed may appear in the examination paper and should be used in students' answers where appropriate.

Some of the study of the set works will also involve identifying key musical themes, chord patterns and rhythms. Examination questions every year will feature musical dictation which could be completing some notes on staff notation/guitar tablature, or identifying a particular rhythm or completing a chord sequence. It is, therefore, important that students study the various types of notation used in the eight set works.

## Areas of study

Students will learn the musical elements, musical contexts and musical language in depth through four compulsory areas of study.

The areas of study are:

- Instrumental Music 1700–1820
- Vocal Music
- Music for Stage and Screen
- Fusions.

These areas of study enable students' listening and appraising to understand music across a variety of styles and genres. Each area of study includes two set works that should be studied in detail.

These set works will enable students to develop their knowledge and understanding of musical elements, musical contexts and musical language in depth, and within the context of the area of study. Teachers should enable students to draw connections and links between the set works within each area of study and also explore the connections with the other areas of study.

For each area of study, students are expected to use appropriate terminology and vocabulary associated with the genres, styles and features of the area of study.

Examples of the words expected to be known and understood by students for use in the examination are found in *Appendix 3: Music Vocabulary List* on page 64.

### Area of Study 1 – Instrumental Music 1700-1820

The pieces selected as set works provide a good representation of instrumental music from the period 1700–1820. The Bach Brandenburg Concerto no. 5, 3rd movement includes a study of fugue in a Gigue dance movement. General features of Baroque music can be analysed in this piece. The Beethoven Piano Sonata no. 8 in C minor is chosen as an example of solo instrumental music. It is a dramatic romantic work in sonata form.

The suggested wider listening works provide a good background and context to the set pieces. The Handel Concerto Grosso complements the Bach work and the Vivaldi Winter from the Four Seasons provides further study of the solo concerto form. The Classical piano sonata movements by Mozart and Haydn provide a good historical introduction to the piano sonata as a genre and prepare for the extended Beethoven sonata movement.